Microsoft Word

Complete Shortcut Keys Reference

All Versions: 2016 · 2019 · 2021 · Microsoft 365

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How to Use This Document: This reference covers 130+ keyboard shortcuts for Microsoft Word. Shortcuts are grouped by function category. Keys shown in `blue monospace` represent the keyboard combination to press. Use Ctrl+F to search for any shortcut quickly.

1. File Operations

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
`Ctrl + N`	Create a new blank document
`Ctrl + O`	Open an existing document
`Ctrl + S`	Save the current document
`Ctrl + Shift + S`	Save As — save with a new name or location
`Ctrl + W`	Close the current document window
`Ctrl + P`	Print the document
`Ctrl + F2`	Open Print Preview
`F12`	Open the Save As dialog box
`Alt + F4`	Exit Microsoft Word
`Ctrl + F6`	Switch between open Word document windows
`Ctrl + F12`	Open a document (same as Ctrl + O)
`Shift + F12`	Save the document (same as Ctrl + S)

2. Basic Editing & Clipboard

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
`Ctrl + A`	Select all content in the document
`Ctrl + C`	Copy selected text or object
`Ctrl + X`	Cut selected text or object
`Ctrl + V`	Paste copied or cut content
`Ctrl + Z`	Undo the last action

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + Y	Redo the last undone action
Ctrl + D	Duplicate selected object / open Font dialog
Delete	Delete the character to the right of cursor
Backspace	Delete the character to the left of cursor
Ctrl + Backspace	Delete the word to the left of cursor
Ctrl + Delete	Delete the word to the right of cursor
Ctrl + Z	Undo last action (repeatable)
Ctrl + Alt + Z	Undo multiple actions (step back)

3. Character Formatting

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + B	Bold — toggle bold formatting on selected text
Ctrl + I	Italic — toggle italic formatting
Ctrl + U	Underline — toggle underline formatting
Ctrl + Shift + D	Double underline the selected text
Ctrl + Shift + W	Underline words only (not spaces)
Ctrl + =	Subscript — lower text below baseline
Ctrl + Shift + =	Superscript — raise text above baseline
Ctrl + Shift + K	Small Caps — format text as small capitals
Ctrl + Shift + A	All Caps — convert text to all uppercase
Ctrl + Shift + H	Hidden text — apply hidden formatting
Ctrl + Shift + Q	Apply Symbol font to selected text
Ctrl + Spacebar	Remove manual character formatting
Shift + F3	Toggle case: UPPER, lower, Title Case
Ctrl + Shift + C	Copy text formatting (Format Painter)
Ctrl + Shift + V	Paste text formatting only

4. Paragraph Formatting & Styles

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + E	Center-align the paragraph

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + L	Left-align the paragraph
Ctrl + R	Right-align the paragraph
Ctrl + J	Justify the paragraph (both edges aligned)
Ctrl + M	Increase paragraph indent
Ctrl + Shift + M	Decrease paragraph indent (remove one level)
Ctrl + T	Create a hanging indent
Ctrl + Shift + T	Reduce a hanging indent
Ctrl + Q	Remove paragraph formatting
Ctrl + 1	Set line spacing to Single
Ctrl + 2	Set line spacing to Double
Ctrl + 5	Set line spacing to 1.5 lines
Ctrl + 0	Add or remove 6-pt spacing before a paragraph
Ctrl + Shift + N	Apply Normal style to paragraph
Ctrl + Alt + 1	Apply Heading 1 style
Ctrl + Alt + 2	Apply Heading 2 style
Ctrl + Alt + 3	Apply Heading 3 style

5. Find, Replace & Navigation

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + F	Find — open the Find pane / Navigation pane
Ctrl + H	Replace — open Find & Replace dialog
Ctrl + G	Go To — navigate to a specific page, section, etc.
F5	Open the Go To tab in Find & Replace dialog
Shift + F4	Repeat the last Find action
Ctrl + Shift + F	Open the Find toolbar in older versions
Alt + Ctrl + Y	Repeat Find after closing Find & Replace

6. Selection & Cursor Movement

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + Home	Move cursor to the beginning of document

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + End	Move cursor to the end of document
Home	Move to the beginning of the current line
End	Move to the end of the current line
Ctrl + ←	Move one word to the left
Ctrl + →	Move one word to the right
Ctrl + ↑	Move up one paragraph
Ctrl + ↓	Move down one paragraph
Page Up	Move up one screen
Page Down	Move down one screen
Shift + ←/→	Extend selection one character left/right
Shift + ↑/↓	Extend selection one line up/down
Ctrl + Shift + ←	Extend selection one word to the left
Ctrl + Shift + →	Extend selection one word to the right
Shift + Home	Select from cursor to beginning of line
Shift + End	Select from cursor to end of line
Ctrl + Shift + Home	Select from cursor to beginning of document
Ctrl + Shift + End	Select from cursor to end of document
Shift + Page Up	Select one screen upward
Shift + Page Down	Select one screen downward
F8	Extend selection mode — click to extend selection
Ctrl + Shift + F8	Select a column in a table

7. Working with Tables

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Tab	Move to the next cell in a table
Shift + Tab	Move to the previous cell in a table
Alt + Home	Move to the first cell of the current row
Alt + End	Move to the last cell of the current row
Alt + Page Up	Move to the first cell of the current column
Alt + Page Down	Move to the last cell of the current column
Alt + Shift + ↑	Sort ascending in table column

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Alt + Shift + ↓	Sort descending in table column
Tab (last cell)	Add a new row at the bottom of the table
Ctrl + Tab	Insert a tab character inside a table cell
Alt + 5 (numpad)	Select entire table (Num Lock OFF)

8. Review, Comments & Tools

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
F7	Run Spelling and Grammar check
Shift + F7	Open the Thesaurus
Ctrl + Shift + E	Toggle Track Changes on/off
Ctrl + Alt + M	Insert a comment
Ctrl + Shift + G	Open Word Count dialog
Alt + Ctrl + S	Split the document window
Ctrl + Alt + V	Paste Special dialog
Alt + Shift + D	Insert current date field
Alt + Shift + T	Insert current time field
Alt + Shift + P	Insert page number field

9. View, Fields & Mail Merge

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + Alt + P	Switch to Print Layout view
Ctrl + Alt + O	Switch to Outline view
Ctrl + Alt + N	Switch to Draft (Normal) view
Alt + Ctrl + R	Switch to Read Mode view (Reading Layout)
Ctrl + F1	Collapse or expand the Ribbon
Alt + F8	Open the Macro dialog box
Alt + F11	Open the Visual Basic Editor (VBA)
Ctrl + Shift + F9	Unlink / remove a field
F11	Go to the next field in the document
Shift + F11	Go to the previous field in the document

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + F9	Insert an empty field { }
F9	Update selected field(s)
Alt + Shift + E	Edit a mail-merge data source
Alt + Shift + N	Merge a document in mail merge

10. Symbols & Special Characters

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + Alt + C	Insert Copyright symbol ©
Ctrl + Alt + R	Insert Registered Trademark symbol ®
Ctrl + Alt + T	Insert Trademark symbol ™
Ctrl + Alt + . (period)	Insert an ellipsis (…)
Alt + Ctrl + Num -	Insert an Em dash (—)
Ctrl + Num -	Insert an En dash (–)
Ctrl + Shift + Spacebar	Insert a non-breaking space
Ctrl + Shift + -	Insert a non-breaking hyphen
Ctrl + -	Insert an optional hyphen
Ctrl + Enter	Insert a manual page break
Ctrl + Shift + Enter	Insert a column break
Alt + Enter	Insert a line break (soft return)

11. Function Keys (F1 – F12 Full Reference)

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
F1	Open Help / Microsoft Word Help pane
F2	Move selected text or graphic (move, then press Enter)
F3	Insert an AutoText entry (type name then F3)
F4	Repeat the last command or action
F5	Open Find & Replace → Go To tab
F6	Move between panes in a split document
F7	Open Spelling & Grammar checker
F8	Activate selection extend mode

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
F9	Update selected fields
F10	Activate the menu bar / Key Tips
F11	Go to the next field
F12	Open Save As dialog
Shift + F1	Reveal Formatting — show formatting details
Shift + F2	Copy selected text
Shift + F3	Change text case (UPPER / lower / Title)
Shift + F4	Repeat last Find / Go To action
Shift + F5	Move to last change or edit location
Shift + F6	Previous pane in split document
Shift + F7	Open Thesaurus
Shift + F8	Shrink / reduce the current selection
Shift + F9	Toggle field code display (selected field)
Shift + F10	Show context / right-click menu
Shift + F11	Go to the previous field
Shift + F12	Save document (same as Ctrl + S)
Ctrl + F1	Expand or collapse the Ribbon
Ctrl + F2	Open Print Preview
Ctrl + F3	Cut text to the Spike
Ctrl + F4	Close the document window
Ctrl + F5	Restore document window size
Ctrl + F6	Next document window
Ctrl + F9	Insert empty field braces { }
Ctrl + F10	Maximize document window
Ctrl + F11	Lock a field (prevent updates)
Ctrl + F12	Open a document (Open dialog)
Ctrl + Shift + F3	Insert the Spike contents
Ctrl + Shift + F5	Open Bookmarks dialog
Ctrl + Shift + F6	Previous open document window
Ctrl + Shift + F7	Update linked information in document
Ctrl + Shift + F8	Extend selection to a column
Ctrl + Shift + F9	Unlink current field
Ctrl + Shift + F11	Unlock a field

Shortcut Key	Description / Function
Ctrl + Shift + F12	Open Print dialog
Alt + F1	Go to next field
Alt + F2	Open Save As dialog
Alt + F3	Create AutoText entry from selection
Alt + F4	Quit Microsoft Word
Alt + F5	Restore program window
Alt + F6	Switch between open Word windows
Alt + F7	Find next misspelling (Auto Spell Check on)
Alt + F8	Open Macro dialog
Alt + F9	Toggle all field codes display
Alt + F10	Maximize program window
Alt + F11	Open Visual Basic Editor

⍰ Pro Tips

- Most shortcuts work on Windows. Mac users replace Ctrl with ⌘Command.
- Use Alt + Letter to navigate the Ribbon without a mouse.
- Press F10 or Alt alone to see Key Tips appear on each Ribbon tab.
- Customize shortcuts via File → Options → Customize Ribbon → Keyboard Shortcuts.
- Press Ctrl + Z immediately after any accidental action — unlimited undo history.

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